CONTRACTOR SUPPORT OF U.S. OPERATIONS IN THE USCENTCOM AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY

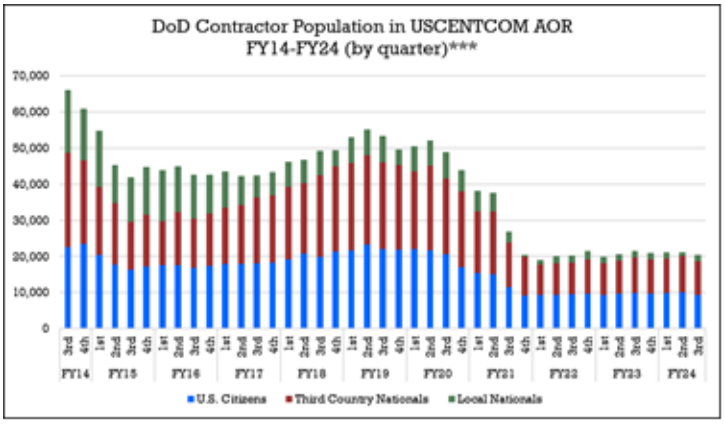
BACKGROUND: This report provides Department of Defense (DoD) contractor personnel numbers for 3rd quarter Fiscal Year 2024 (FY24) and the current status of efforts underway to improve management of contractors accompanying United States (U.S.) Forces. It includes data on DoD contractor personnel deployed in Iraq and Syria, Operation Inherent Resolve (OIR), and the U.S. Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR).

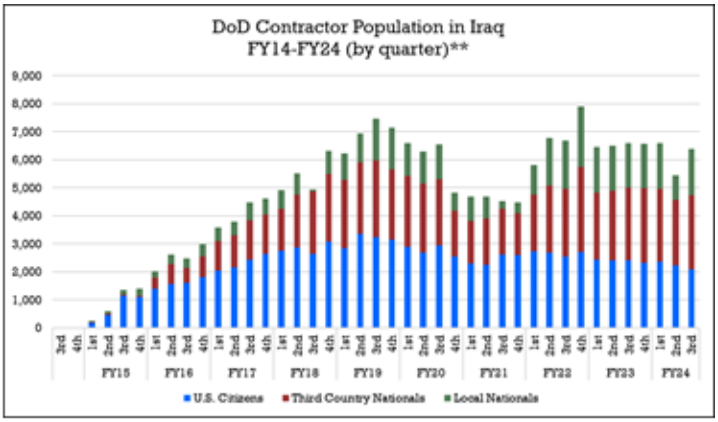
KEY POINTS: During 3rd quarter FY24, USCENTCOM reported approximately 20,384 contractor personnel supporting DoD in the USCENTCOM AOR, a decrease of approximately 712 from the previous quarter.

DoD Contractor Personnel in the USCENTCOM AOR

	Total Contractors	U.S. Citizens	Third Country Nationals (TCN)	Local Nationals
Iraq and Syria	6,387	2,082	2,647	1,658
Other USCENTCOM Locations	13,997	7,237	6,667	93
USCENTCOM AOR	20,384	9,319	9,314	1,751

DoD Contractor Population Trends (FY14–FY24)*





* To maintain a 10-year quarterly view of contractor populations, the date range has been changed to reflect FY14-FY24 data.

** Information on the contractor population in Syria was incorporated starting 2nd quarter FY18.

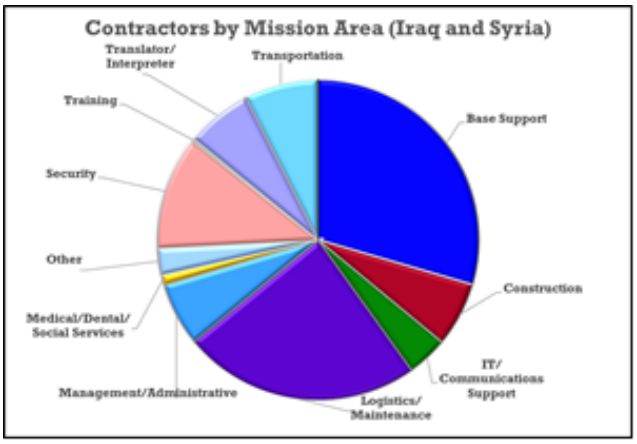
*** Information on the contractor population in Israel is included in the USCENTCOM AOR totals starting in 4th quarter FY21.

Prepared by: ODASD(Log) July 2024

OIR (Iraq and Syria) Summary

- The distribution of contractors in Iraq and Syria by mission category are:

Base Support	1,884	(29.5%)
Construction	415	(6.5%)
IT/Communications Support	262	(4.1%)
Logistics/Maintenance	1,533	(24.0%)
Management/Administrative	409	(6.4%)
Medical/Dental/Social Services	64	(1.0%)
Other	172	(2.7%)
Security	728	(11.4%)
Training	19	(0.3%)
Translator/Interpreter	422	(6.6%)
Transportation	479	(7.5%)
Total:	6,387	



  - Contractor Posture: Approximately 6,387 DoD contractors directly supported DoD-funded contracts in Iraq and Syria. This is an increase of 17.1% from 2nd quarter FY24. This decrease is mostly attributable to the start of a new option year for a single contract.

- **USCENTCOM Operational Contract Support (OCS) Branch (CCJ43):**
  - **Vendor Threat Mitigation (VTM).** During this quarter, CCJ43 reviewed 43 vendors; 13 vendors (30%) were rated an "acceptable" force protection risk and 28 (65%) were identified as "unacceptable without mitigation." Vendors rated as "unacceptable without mitigation" require completion of a risk mitigation plan or installation access denial letter. The USCENTCOM Deputy Commander approved six Section 841 identification packages, bringing the total number of identified entities to 59 and individuals to 100. CCJ43 also briefed the VTM Executive Council on USCENTCOM VTM resourcing challenges, threat trends, and program best practices.

  - During this quarter, CCJ43 focus has been the coordination of OCS in support of the Gaza Foreign Humanitarian Assistance Joint Logistics Over the Shore (JLOTS) mission. This coordination ensured critical contract support efforts were synchronized and timely contracting support was provided for this critical mission. CCJ43 also developed the Annex W and supporting appendices for a priority operation plan (OPLAN) effort. CCJ43 coordinated with Defense Contract Management Agency, Combat Support Center to ensure the OCS Annex (Annex W) and the Logistics Annex (Annex D) appropriately reflected current contingency contract administration services policy and has OCS correctly nested within the logistics annex and overall concept of logistics support. Finally, CCJ43 briefed the OCS Functional Capabilities Integration Board (FCIB) on a key OPLAN, the JLOTS mission, and the USCENTCOM OCS common operating picture.

  - **Combined Joint Task Force - Operation INHERENT RESOLVE (CJTF-OIR) Operational Contract Support Integration Cell (OCSIC):** During this quarter, the CJTF-OIR OCSIC traveled to Baghdad to broker a new five-year, $441 million Interagency Agreement between the Department of State and CJTF-OIR. This agreement supports the base operating support-integrator services and logistics personnel at four different locations across Iraq. The OCSIC team continues to focus on meeting the full operational capability timeline of a new, geographically strategic, operating base in Syria

(Northern Landing Zone). The OCSIC played a significant role in shaping the Operational Basing Working Group, ensuring alignment with future OIR campaign plans, and planned base closures.

IMPROVEMENTS TO MANAGEMENT AND OVERSIGHT OF DOD CONTRACTORS

- **Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics (ODASD(Log)):**
  - **OCS Governance and Oversight.** On May 21, 2024, the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics and the Vice Director for Logistics, (JS J4) co-chaired the 3rd quarter FY24 OCS FCIB meeting. The included an update from USCENTCOM on its OCS program and current operations and annual updates from the DoD OCS Education and Training and OCS Data and Information Group (DIG) on current initiatives. No significant issues were reported, and the community continues to work toward establishing OCS as an enduring joint capability. The next meeting will be held on August 27, 2024.
  - The FY24-28 DoD OCS Action Plan was finalized and published on June 11, 2024. After twelve iterations, this is will be the final annual publication. To allow sufficient time to address complex issues, the Department will transition to a biennial publication schedule in September 2025, starting with the FY26-30 action plan.
  - **OCS Joint Capability Improvement Working Group (CIWG) Update.** On April 18, 2024, the CIWG convened to discuss resolution of open actions, and to review DoD OCS Education and Training initiatives across the enterprise. Offices of Primary Responsibility continue to engage and are on track to complete several outstanding open actions by the end of the fiscal year. The next OCS CIWG meeting will be held on July 18, 2024.
  - **Defense Standards for Security Services:**
    - All DoD contracts for private security services require compliance with American National Standard Institute (ANSI) PSC.1-2012 (R2017), "Quality Management Standard for Private Security Company Operations" or International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 18788-2015 "Management Systems for Private Security Operations." All private security companies contracted by DoD at any tier are currently compliant with one or both of the existing standards and have achieved independent third-party certification.
    - The DoD continues to review plans and timelines for companies to transition to the revised standard, ANSI/ASIS PSC.1-2022 "Management System for Private Security Company Operations—Requirements with Guidance."
    - A total of 112 private security companies from 35 different countries have achieved independent third-party certification to one or both standards.
- **JS J45, OCSD:**
  - **Assessments and Reporting.** J45 OCSD conducted a Reporting Working Group (RWG) meeting on May 2, 2024. Participants included personnel from the Combatant Commands, Services, and Agencies. During the RWG forum, Services and Agencies shared best practices and described how they are maturing their risk-assessment programs.

- **OCS in Planning.** J45 OCSD engaged with and supported efforts of the Army and Navy to enhance visibility of contractors in contingency plans.
  - **Naval Supply Systems Command (NAVSUP) Worldwide Expeditionary Multiple Award Contract (WEXMAC).** J45 OCSD participated in a workshop held May 15-17, 2024, that brought together WEXMAC planners and web developers and J45 OCSD to develop ways to make WEXMAC capabilities visible to DoD planners in contingency planning.
  - **Joint Planning and Execution Community (JPEC) Action Group (JAG).** J45 OCSD participated in the JAG conference June 3-7, 2024, to continue the integration of contracted capabilities into elements of global force management.
  - **Logistics Supplement (LOGSUP) to the Joint Strategic Campaign Plan (JSCP).** J45 OCSD also provided pre-worldwide coordination edits to the LOGSUP to the JSCP, incorporating context and guidance to the logistics community regarding OCS.
- **Individual Training.**
  - **Joint OCS Planning and Execution Course (JOPEC).** During the 3rd quarter FY24, J45 OCSD trained 49 students, through both remote-learning and an in-person JOPEC offering hosted by the U.S. European Command.
  - **Joint Enabling Capabilities Command (JECC), Joint Planning Support Element (JPSE), Joint Enhanced Training (JET).** J45 OCSD facilitated JET events for 70 JPSE planners and mentors at the JECC from May 17-19, 2024, focusing on rapidly establishing a joint task force headquarters in the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM) area of responsibility.
  - **Joint Knowledge Online (JKO).** J45 OCSD continues to develop a four-phase suite of training to replace the current Joint OCS Essentials for Commanders and Staff suite. The first two phases are available to students on the JKO platform:
    - OCS I, *Leveraging Commercial Capabilities Across the Competition Continuum*. A total of 2,436 students have completed OCS I to date.
    - OCS II, *OCS Fundamentals*. A total of 793 students have completed OCS II to date.
  - **Joint Engineer Operations Course (JEOC).** On April 9 and June 4, 2024, J45 OCSD delivered a presentation to a total of 109 operational engineers at the JEOC at the U.S. Army Engineer School.
  - **Joint Logistics Course (JLC), Army Sustainment University.** J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction at three sessions of the JLC, on April 4, May 9, and June 13, 2024, to a total of 112 attendees.
- **OCS in Exercises.**
  - **Partner and Interorganizational Integration Conference (PIIC).** J45 OCSD participated in the Integrating Allied and Partner Capacity Wargame II at the Institute for Defense Analyses, June 24-27, 2024. J45 OCSD's participation allowed OCS concepts to be incorporated into the USINDOPACOM-focused wargame, which focused on fuels,

munitions, storage, and base operating support within a resilient logistics network to support U.S. and allied forces.